Theme 4 title 2 Child Edition

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THE CLUE IN THE GARDEN
A Fun Adventure Through the First Book of the Bible
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A Note for Parents

Have you ever played a game of hide and seek? Someone hides. Someone seeks. The seeker looks everywhere. They look under the bed. They look in the closet. They look behind the door. They are looking for clues. They are looking for the hidden one. The first book of the Bible is like a game of hide and seek. God hid clues. He hid them in stories. He hid them in symbols. He hid them in a garden. And the clues all point to one person. They all point to Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to search for the clues. We are going to find the hidden Savior. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to put on your detective hats. Get ready to follow the clues. Get ready to find Jesus.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Clue of the Beginning

The Secret Clue (OT)
"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

This is the very first clue in the Bible. It is the very first verse. It says, "In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." God made everything. He made the sky. He made the ground. He made the sun. He made the moon. He made the stars. He made it all. And this is the very first clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God." - John 1:1

The Gospel of John starts with the same words. "In the beginning." But John tells us about the Word. The Word was with God. The Word was God. The Word is Jesus. Jesus was there in the very beginning. He was there when God created everything. He is the very first clue.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of something God made. A tree. A star. An animal. Write the name "Jesus" at the top. Talk about how Jesus was there in the beginning.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for making everything. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He was there in the beginning. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful world with a big bright sun and a little heart in the middle.

Day 02: The Clue of the Light

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light." - Genesis 1:3

The world was dark. It was empty. It was quiet. Then God spoke. He said, "Let there be light." And there was light. The light was bright. The light was good. The light was the very first thing God made. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the light of the world. He is the one who shines in the darkness. He is the one who makes the dark places bright. The light in the beginning is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Turn off the lights in your room. Sit in the dark for a moment. Then turn on a light. Talk about how Jesus is the light that makes everything bright.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the light. Thank you for shining in the darkness. Thank you for making my heart bright. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A bright candle shining in a dark room with a big smile.

Day 03: The Clue of the Sky

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be a vault between the waters to separate water from water.'" - Genesis 1:6

God made the sky. He separated the water below from the water above. He made a space. He made a home for the birds. He made a home for the clouds. It was a beautiful sky. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the firstborn over all creation. He is the one who made the sky. He is the one who made the clouds. He is the one who made the birds. The sky is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Go outside. Look at the sky. Look at the clouds. Look at the birds. Talk about how Jesus made all of it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the sky. Thank you for the clouds. Thank you for the birds. Thank you for the beautiful world. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A bright blue sky with fluffy white clouds and a little bird.

Day 04: The Clue of the Land

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let the water under the sky be gathered to one place, and let dry ground appear.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:9

God made the land. He gathered the water together. He made the dry ground appear. He made the mountains. He made the valleys. He made the beaches. It was a beautiful land. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The earth is the LORD's, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it; for he founded it on the seas and established it on the waters." - Psalm 24:1-2

Jesus is the Lord of the earth. He is the one who made the land. He is the one who made the mountains. He is the one who made the beaches. The land is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a mountain or a beach. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus made the land.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the land. Thank you for the mountains. Thank you for the beaches. Thank you for the beautiful world. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful mountain with a green valley and a little tree.

Day 05: The Clue of the Plants

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let the land produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and trees on the land that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their various kinds.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:11

God made the plants. He made the grass. He made the flowers. He made the trees. He made the fruit. He made the seeds. He made it all. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. He is the source of life. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. The plants are a clue. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Plant a seed in a cup. Water it. Put it in the sun. Watch it grow over the next few weeks. Talk about how Jesus makes things grow.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the plants. Thank you for the flowers. Thank you for the trees. Thank you for the fruit. Thank you for making things grow. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful garden with flowers, trees, and a big smile.

Day 06: The Clue of the Sun and Moon

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be lights in the vault of the sky to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark sacred times, and days and years.'" - Genesis 1:14

God made the sun. He made the moon. He made the stars. He made them to shine. He made them to give light. He made them to mark the days and the nights. And they are clues about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the greater light. He is the light that never goes out. The sun and the moon are clues. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Go outside at night. Look at the moon. Look at the stars. Talk about how Jesus made them. Talk about how He is the light that never goes out.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the sun. Thank you for making the moon. Thank you for making the stars. Thank you for being the light that never goes out. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big sun in the day and a big moon and stars at night.

Day 07: The Clue of the Sea Creatures

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living thing with which the water teems and that moves about in it, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:21

God made the sea creatures. He made the big fish. He made the little fish. He made the whales. He made the birds. He made them all. He saw them. He called them good. And they are clues about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. 'Come, follow me,' Jesus said, 'and I will send you out to fish for people.'" - Matthew 4:18-19

Jesus called fishermen. He called them to follow Him. He called them to fish for people. The sea creatures are clues. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a fish. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus called the fishermen to follow Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the fish. Thank you for making the birds. Thank you for calling the fishermen. Thank you for calling me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big fish with a big smile and a little bird flying above.

Day 08: The Clue of the Animals

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and all the creatures that move along the ground according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:25

God made the animals. He made the lions. He made the lambs. He made the elephants. He made the bugs. He made them all. He saw them. He called them good. And they are clues about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

Jesus is the Lamb. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. The animals are clues. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the Lamb of God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making the animals. Thank you for the lions. Thank you for the lambs. Thank you for being the Lamb of God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a big smile and a little heart.

Day 09: The Clue of the People

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let us make mankind in our image, in our likeness, so that they may rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky, over the livestock and all the wild animals, and over all the creatures that move along the ground.'" - Genesis 1:26

God made people. He made the very first people. He made Adam. He made Eve. He made them in His image. He made them to be like Him. He made them to rule over the earth. And they are clues about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the true image. He is the perfect likeness. The people are clues. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Look in the mirror. Talk about how you are made in the image of God. Talk about how Jesus is the perfect image of God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for making me. Thank you for making me in your image. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He is the perfect image of God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A happy family holding hands with a big heart in the middle.

Day 10: The Clue of the Rest

The Secret Clue (OT)
"By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work. Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done." - Genesis 2:2-3

God made everything in six days. Then He rested. He stopped. He took a break. He enjoyed what He made. He blessed the seventh day. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the rest. He is the one who gives rest. He is the one who gives peace. The rest is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Take a nap. Read a book. Go for a walk. Do something restful. Talk about how Jesus gives us rest.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for rest. Thank you for giving me rest. Thank you for giving me peace. Help me to rest in you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A person sleeping peacefully with a big smile and a little "Zzz."

Day 11: The Clue of the Garden

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. The LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:8-9

God planted a garden. He planted it in Eden. He put the man there. He made trees grow. Trees that were pretty. Trees that had food. In the middle of the garden was the tree of life. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Then Jesus said to them, 'Very truly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.'" - John 6:53-54

Jesus is the tree of life. He is the one who gives eternal life. The garden is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a garden. Draw a tree in the middle. Write the name "Jesus" on the tree. Talk about how Jesus is the tree of life.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the tree of life. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for giving me eternal life. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful garden with a big tree in the middle and a big smile.

Day 12: The Clue of the River

The Secret Clue (OT)
"A river watering the garden flowed from Eden; from there it was separated into four headwaters." - Genesis 2:10

A river flowed from Eden. It watered the garden. It brought life. It brought refreshment. It brought blessing. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them. By this he meant the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were later to receive." - John 7:38-39

Jesus is the river of living water. He is the source of life. He is the source of refreshment. The river is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Drink a glass of water. As you drink it, talk about how Jesus is the living water. Talk about how He refreshes our souls.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being the living water. Thank you for refreshing my soul. Thank you for filling me up. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful river flowing through a garden with a big smile.

Day 13: The Clue of the Command

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17

God gave a command. He gave a rule. He said, "You can eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." It was a test. It was a boundary. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the rule. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the rule. He never sinned. The command is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Simon Says." Talk about how Jesus always obeyed. Talk about how He kept the rules for us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for obeying. Thank you for keeping the rules. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to obey you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a checkmark inside it.

Day 14: The Clue of the Helper

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him.'" - Genesis 2:18

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." He made a helper. He made a companion. He made Eve. It was a gift. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another advocate to help you and be with you forever—the Spirit of truth." - John 14:16-17

Jesus promised a helper. He promised the Holy Spirit. He promised a companion. The helper is a clue. It points to the Holy Spirit.

Family Activity
Write down one thing you need help with. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to help you. Thank Him for being your helper.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the helper. Thank you for the Holy Spirit. Thank you for being with me. Thank you for helping me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two friends holding hands with a big heart between them.

Day 15: The Clue of the Rib

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But for Adam no suitable helper was found. So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the place with flesh. Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man." - Genesis 2:20-22

God caused Adam to fall asleep. He took a rib. He made a woman. He brought her to the man. It was a strange story. It was a beautiful story. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For we are members of his body. 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church." - Ephesians 5:30-32

Paul says the story of Adam and Eve is a mystery. It is about Christ and the church. Jesus slept in death. He took a wound in his side. He created the church. The rib is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the church. Thank you for making me part of your family. Thank you for making me belong. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A church building with a big heart on the door.

Day 16: The Clue of the Snake

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, "You must not eat from any tree in the garden"?'" - Genesis 3:1

The snake was sneaky. He was tricky. He asked the woman a question. He tried to trick her. He tried to make her doubt God. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray." - Revelation 12:9

The snake is the devil. He is Satan. He is the one who tries to trick us. But Jesus defeated him. Jesus crushed his head. The snake is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a snake. Then draw a big shoe stepping on it. Write the word "Jesus wins!" Talk about how Jesus defeated the snake.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for defeating the snake. Thank you for winning the victory. Help me to resist temptation. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shoe stepping on a snake with a big glowing smile.

Day 17: The Clue of the Sad Day

The Secret Clue (OT)
"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6

The woman saw the fruit. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. They disobeyed. They sinned. It was a sad day. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He brought righteousness into the world. The sad day is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Talk about a time you made a mistake. Talk about how Jesus took your mistake. Thank Him for His grace.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for taking my mistakes. Thank you for giving me your goodness. Help me to obey you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A sad face turning into a happy face with a big heart.

Day 18: The Clue of the Fig Leaves

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. They felt ashamed. They tried to cover themselves with fig leaves. They tried to fix their own problem. But it did not work. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the true covering. He is the true clothing. He covers our shame. He covers our sin. The fig leaves are a clue. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. Talk about how Jesus covers us. Talk about how He takes away our shame.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for covering me. Thank you for taking away my shame. Thank you for clothing me with your love. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A warm winter coat with a big heart on it.

Day 19: The Clue of the Question

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But the LORD God called to the man, 'Where are you?'" - Genesis 3:9

God called to Adam. He said, "Where are you?" It was a question. It was a search. God was looking for Adam. He was seeking him. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the seeker. He is the one who comes looking. He is the one who calls. He is the one who saves. The question is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Play a game of hide and seek. Let your child hide. Then find them and say, "I always find you!" Talk about how Jesus always finds us.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for seeking me. Thank you for finding me. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An eye looking for something with a big heart next to it.

Day 20: The Clue of the Promise

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15

God spoke to the snake. He said, "A descendant of the woman will come. He will crush your head." It was the very first promise. It was the very first clue. And it points to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)

"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the descendant. He was born of a woman. He crushed the snake's head. The promise is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Write down one promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His promises.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the promise. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the snake's head. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big heart with a cross inside it and a big smile.

Day 21: The Clue of the Sacrifice

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21

God made clothes for Adam and Eve. He made them out of animal skin. An animal had to die. Blood had to be shed. It was the very first sacrifice. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the sacrifice. He is the covering. His blood was shed. His life was given. The first sacrifice is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His love. Thank Him for His sacrifice.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the sacrifice. Thank you for covering me. Thank you for loving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A warm coat with a big heart and a cross on it.

Day 22: The Clue of the Exile

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23

God sent Adam out of the garden. He had to leave. He had to go. It was a sad day. It was the very first exile. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our access. He brings us into grace. The exile is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A door opening into a beautiful garden with a big smile.

Day 23: The Clue of the Guards

The Secret Clue (OT)
"After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life." - Genesis 3:24

God placed angels at the garden. They were guards. They had a flaming sword. They guarded the way to the tree of life. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit. At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:50-51

Jesus removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. The guards are a clue. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity

Draw a picture of a curtain. Then draw a line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for opening the way. Thank you for removing the barrier. Thank you for letting me come to God. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A torn curtain with a big heart and a cross.

Day 24: The Clue of the Brothers

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8

Cain was jealous. He was angry. He killed his brother Abel. It was the very first murder. It was a sad day. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the innocent one. He is the one who was killed. The first brothers are a clue. They point to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for understanding my pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Help me to forgive those who have hurt me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a bandage on it and a big smile.

Day 25: The Clue of the Blood

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10

Abel's blood cried out. It cried out for justice. It cried out from the ground. It was the very first blood. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy. The first blood is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His grace.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for your blood. Thank you for speaking forgiveness over me. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a drop of blood and a big smile.

Day 26: The Clue of the Boat

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So make yourself an ark of cypress wood; make rooms in it and coat it with pitch inside and out." - Genesis 6:14

God told Noah to build a boat. It was a big boat. It was called an ark. It was a rescue. It was a safe place. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit." - 1 Peter 3:18

Jesus is the ark. He is the rescue. He is the safe place. He suffered for sins. He brought us to God. The first boat is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a boat. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Thank Him for being your ark. Thank Him for saving you.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my ark. Thank you for being my rescue. Thank you for saving me. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt

A big boat with animals and a rainbow and a big smile.

Day 27: The Clue of the Rainbow

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13

God set a rainbow in the clouds. It was a sign. It was a promise. It was a reminder. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who saves. The rainbow is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

Kid's Prayer

……..

Day 27: The Clue of the Rainbow (Continued)

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the rainbow. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for keeping your promises. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A beautiful rainbow stretching across the sky with a big smile.

Day 28: The Clue of the Tower

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4

The people wanted to build a tower. They wanted to reach heaven. They wanted to make a name for themselves. They wanted to be famous. But God had a different plan. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a name for himself. He did not build a tower. He came down from heaven. He made a name that is above every name. The tower is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Build a tower out of blocks. See how high you can make it. Then knock it down. Talk about how Jesus is the one who makes a name that lasts forever.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down to reach me. Help me to trust your name. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A tall tower with a big smile and a little heart at the top.

Day 29: The Clue of the Call

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The LORD had said to Abram, 'Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you.'" - Genesis 12:1

God called Abraham. He told him to leave his home. He told him to leave his family. He told him to go to a new land. It was the start of a new adventure. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Come, follow me," Jesus said, "and I will send you out to fish for people." - Matthew 4:19

Jesus calls us. He tells us to follow Him. He tells us to leave our old life behind. He tells us to go where He leads. The call is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think of a step of faith you need to take. Write it down. Ask God to help you take it. Ask Him to help you follow the call.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the call. Thank you for calling me. Help me to answer the call. Help me to follow you. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A person walking on a path with a big smile and a bright light ahead.

Day 30: The Clue of the Promise

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will make you into a great nation. I will bless you. I will make your name great. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." It was a promise. It was a hope. And it is a clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The promise to Abraham is a clue. It points to Jesus.

Family Activity
Think about your family. Write down one way you can be a blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the promise. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me part of your family. Help me to be a blessing to others. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big family with a big heart in the middle and a shining star above.

END MATTER

The "Story Detective" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Clue in the Garden adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Story Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was your favorite clue from this book?
Card 2: What was the coolest story you learned about?
Card 3: Why do you think God hid so many clues about Jesus?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus was there in the very beginning?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days searching for clues with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Big Beginning

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Big Beginning takes you on a journey through how the first stories of the Bible point to Jesus. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, beautiful garden. In the middle of the garden is a large tree. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. The title THE CLUE IN THE GARDEN is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word CLUE is in bright red with a magnifying glass replacing the letter C. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.